Travel Log – Japan (Tokyo)

October 15

We started the day at 3 o'clock in the morning on our way back through our rest station- Tokyo which is getting a whiff of the Cyclone that hit Japan today. The last hour of the flight was fright due to the serious turbulences the captain didn't help much when he said on approach: "In case of an evacuation do not take with you any of your personal belongings" .very comforting indeed. We are now in an economy hotel the size if our Tel-Aviv apartment. It is pouring cats and dogs and promises to continue tomorrow. In this deluge we went for a quick bite and the first place we hit is a Japanese bar celebrating Oktoberfest with German sausages and Strauss waltzes in the background. Go figure.

October 16

We are sipping coffee on the Ginza and watching people: lots of young Japanese in the "national" uniforms: black suits, white shirts and striped ties. It's like a professional "Army". Also many young women (in particular) with their heads bowed and eyes locked up on smartphone screens occasionally extending their hands to avoid walking into a wall. This has become a universal posture for humans under 30 it seems. What a cultural shocking difference between Bangkok and Tokyo. We walked about town, visited the Daimaru department store and were fascinated by the sweet floor, the variety and appetizing display of deserts.Late lunch at Happo En next to a beautiful Japanese Garden. Must be time to go home says mom's clock. Mom is done like dinner and we are back in the hotel before sunset.
















LE CAFÉ DOUTOR
GINZA
DOUTOR






October 17

We started the day way too early. We set the alarm for 2:30AM in order to be at the famous Tuna auction at the fish market at 3:00 as we were told. We are first in line alright but the registration doesn't start till 5:00 AM and the real show not until 5:25. Even for football matches this is way too early. The market itself is busy bee like in mid-day (or is this mid-day) but as tourists we learned that you got to do what you got to do, so we wait. We're just talking observing that contrary to our expectations and by contrast to all other places we visited Japanese don't speak comprehensible English, at least not in the services, hospitality, food industry. This is somewhat surprising. So we waited and finally witnessed the famous Tuna auction. There once was a comedian in Israel who always, no matter the topic, came back to talking sex. When asked the question what is the most pleasurable thing in life, he, after a deliberate pause responded: "It's not what you think, it's having a cigarette afterwards". So it wasn't the auction so much as the traditional sushi breakfast at 6:10AM- good (for me not mom who continues her "love affair" with Asian food to the last day of our trip). Not cheap though at $70 but pretty well mandatory.








At 7:30 AM we are back in bed. It's going to be a trying 48 hours or so before we come home. It's time. It feels like two days in one. This afternoon we are sitting in a side walk Cafe in the middle of the Ginza just watching people. We are so tired, let them come to us. We "covered" Shibuya and the famous crossing although once again, may be too early at 4PM not as overwhelming as we expected by the publicity. Truth be told we're going through the motions and waiting for the trip home. It's been an unbelievable experience one that we'll never

forget. .Everything is well that ends well so here is the last photo of Mme. Cordon Bleu biting on a French croissant and sipping on an Italian Cappuccino. What a life?

